



Brain Dump Scoring.

Content brain dumps · Fall 2026 · Faculty copy

Four levels. Three points is the top score. Use the same four levels on every content brain dump, in all three sections, all term. Do not give this sheet to students.

Solano Community College · Fall 2026

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THE SCALE

What each level means

3

POINTS

Above and beyond

Everything a 2 has, plus something the prompt did not ask for.

- A link back to earlier material, or forward to something not taught yet
- A clinical example, a mechanism, or a consequence of the structure being wrong
- A worked distinction between two things students routinely confuse
- An organizing map, a drawing, or a memory hook the student built themselves
- Reasoning shown, not just the product

2

POINTS

Fundamentals plus a reach

The fundamentals are complete, and the student went past recall into relationship.

- Every part the prompt asked for is present and correct
- Comparison, ordering, or structure tied to function rather than a bare list
- A drawing that carries relationships, not just labels
- Nothing substantive missing, nothing substantive wrong

1

POINT

The basic idea is there

The fundamental idea is present and correct as far as it goes. Incomplete is fine at this level. What is on the page is not wrong.

- Names the thing, lists the main parts, or gets the core definition
- Gaps are visible but the student clearly attempted retrieval
- One or two errors inside otherwise sound work still sits here

0

POINTS

Nothing usable

Blank, a handful of scattered words, or a scribble with no attempt at organization.

- No attempt at retrieval
- Copied from a neighbour or from open resources during round 1

WORKED EXAMPLE

One prompt, three levels

The four primary tissues. Name the four primary tissue types. For each, write one defining feature and two locations.

WHAT A 1 LOOKS LIKE

Epithelial, connective, muscle, nervous. One or two features attached, locations thin or missing. Nothing on the page is wrong, there is simply not much of it yet.

WHAT A 2 LOOKS LIKE

All four named, a correct defining feature for each, two real locations each. Possibly a column layout or a small sketch. Complete and organized, and it stops where the prompt stopped.

WHAT A 3 LOOKS LIKE

All of that, and then the student explains why the defining feature predicts the locations they listed, or sketches the two they keep confusing side by side, or hangs the subtypes off each of the four as a map.

HOW TO RUN IT

Operating notes

Grade round 1 only, and only what is in the first colour.

The score is for what the student wrote with everything closed. Do not score anything added afterwards, whether it came from the site, from their notes, or from a teammate. That is why students are told to do round 1 in one colour and make every correction in a second colour.

Use these same four levels on every content brain dump, in all three sections, from week 1 to week 17.

Do not raise the bar for an easy prompt or lower it for a hard one. If the levels stay fixed, a 2 in November means the same thing as a 2 in August, and you can show a student their own trend across the term.

Do not use this scale on a learning brain dump.

The metacognitive prompts are scored some other way, which is still to be decided. They are also not in the student practice bank, so students cannot rehearse an answer to one.

You do not have to run the check in class.

Three options, all fine. Collect the dumps at the end of round 1 and mark them yourself. Check in the room against the resources. Or hand the check to the teams. The workbook tells students they will not know in advance which one they are getting.

Sort into four piles. Do not argue about half points.

Read for the fundamentals first. Then ask whether the student went past recall into relationships. Then ask whether they added something the prompt did not ask for. Most dumps are a 1 or a 2 and take about fifteen seconds each.

Open

Two things are not decided yet. First, how a learning brain dump is scored. Second, whether a student sees the raw 0 to 3 in Canvas or a percentage.